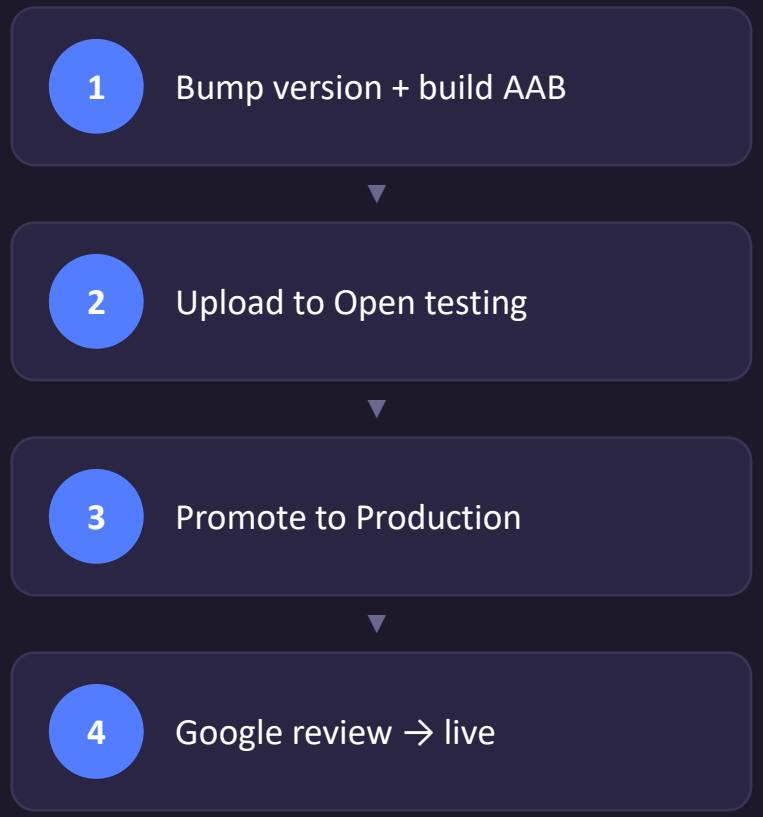
KONNECT ANDROID · KNOWLEDGE TRANSFER

Play Store Release Runbook

How a build gets from the repo to Google Play:
bump → build the AAB → Open testing → promote to Production → Google review → live.



com.konnect.kr · Play Console + Gradle · September 2026

OVERVIEW

The release flow at a glance

1. **Bump version**
   Repo
   app.json + build.gradle
2. **Build the AAB**
   Terminal
   gradlew bundleRelease
3. **Upload to Open testing**
   Play Console
   Create new release
4. **Verify on a phone**
   Device
   Sign-in, search, cashback
5. **Promote to Production**
   Play Console
   Same bundle, no rebuild
6. **Google review**
   Google
   Hours to a few days
7. **Live on Play**
   Play Console
   “Available on Google Play”

One bundle per release

The AAB you test is the AAB that ships. Promotion moves it; it is never rebuilt.

versionCode only goes up

Play rejects any code it has already seen. Codes need not be consecutive, only larger.

Nothing is live until Google approves

With managed publishing off, an approved release publishes itself.

PREREQUISITES

Before you start: access, key, toolchain

Play Console access

- Owner or Release manager on the Konnect developer account
- App: Konnect (com.konnect.kr)
- play.google.com/console → Test and release

Upload keystore (never in the repo)

- ~/konnect-upload.keystore · alias konnect-upload
- Cert CN=Konnect, OU=Mobile, valid to Dec 2053
- SHA-1 37:37:70:3E:69:6A:37:FC:56:74:71:23:B4:51:6D:18:7A:C6:0D:33
- Backed up off-machine — losing it locks the listing

Gradle signing properties

- ~/.gradle/gradle.properties on the build machine:
- KONNECT_UPLOAD_STORE_FILE / _STORE_PASSWORD
- KONNECT_UPLOAD_KEY_ALIAS / _KEY_PASSWORD
- Missing → release silently signs with the debug key

Toolchain

- Node 22, JDK 17, Android SDK + build-tools 37
- Repo on the release branch, `npm install` done
- Android project lives in android/ (not committed)
- docs/RELEASE.md is the written source of truth

STEP 1 · REPO

1 Bump the version in two files

EDIT BOTH — KEEP versionName == expo.version

```
// app.json
"expo": {
  "version": "1.0.6",
  ...
}

// android/app/build.gradle  (defaultConfig)
versionCode 8
versionName "1.0.6"
```

The rule Play enforces

versionCode must be strictly greater than every code ever uploaded to any track. "Version code N has already been used" means bump it again. Codes need not be consecutive — 7 was built locally and never uploaded, so 8 followed 6.

Upload history (Play Console → Latest releases and bundles)

Code	Name	Uploaded	Status
3	1.0.2	Aug 22, 2026	Inactive
4	1.0.3	Aug 25, 2026	Inactive
5	1.0.4	Aug 28, 2026	Active
6	1.0.5	Sep 14, 2026	Production · available
8	**1.0.6**	Sep 30, 2026	**Production · in review**

Next release: versionCode 9, versionName 1.0.7 (or 1.1.0 for a feature release).

Commit the bump

Commit app.json and build.gradle together with the release, so the next person sees which code is already taken.

STEP 2 · REPO

2 Point the build at the right API host

- The API host is compiled into the JS bundle at build time — it cannot be changed after the build.
- It is one constant: DEFAULT_API_HOST in src/config/index.ts. Today it is https://staging.konnect.kr.
- Store releases must be built against the host the release is meant for. Decide, edit the constant, commit it with the version bump.
- Metro caches the transformed module, so purge its cache and run gradlew clean before the build, or the old host stays baked in.

SET THE HOST

```
// src/config/index.ts
const DEFAULT_API_HOST = 'https://api.konnect.kr';

# purge Metro cache, then clean
rm -rf "$LOCALAPPDATA/Temp/metro-cache" "$LOCALAPPDATA/Temp/metro-file-map-"*
cd android && ./gradlew clean
```

VERIFY WHAT GOT BAKED

```
# after the build: what host is actually inside the artifact?
unzip -p android/app/build/outputs/bundle/release/app-release.aab \
  base/assets/index.android.bundle | grep -aoE "https://[a-z0-9.-]*konnect\.kr" | sort -u

# expect exactly one line, e.g.
https://api.konnect.kr
```

Why this step exists

Two builds in September went out with the staging host because Metro reused a cached bundle from an earlier build. Editing the constant, purging the cache and running the verify command on the finished AAB is the combination that proved reliable. The verify takes two seconds — run it every time.

Replace api.konnect.kr with the agreed production host; staging is the default today.

STEP 3 · TERMINAL

3 Build the AAB and verify it before upload

BUILD → COPY → VERIFY

```
# 1. build (3–5 min)
cd android && ./gradlew bundleRelease
# → android/app/build/outputs/bundle/release/app-release.aab

# 2. keep a copy in release/ named by version
cp android/app/build/outputs/bundle/release/app-release.aab release/konnect-v1.0.6.aab

# 3. who signed it?  (must be CN=Konnect, not CN=Android Debug)
keytool -printcert -jarfile release/konnect-v1.0.6.aab | grep -E "Owner|SHA1"
Owner: CN=Konnect, OU=Mobile, O=Konnect, L=Seoul, C=KR
SHA1: 37:37:70:3E:69:6A:37:FC:56:74:71:23:B4:51:6D:18:7A:C6:0D:33

# 4. which version is inside?
aapt2 dump badging android/app/build/outputs/apk/release/app-release.apk | grep -o
"versionCode='[0-9]*' versionName='[^']*'"
versionCode='8' versionName='1.0.6'
```

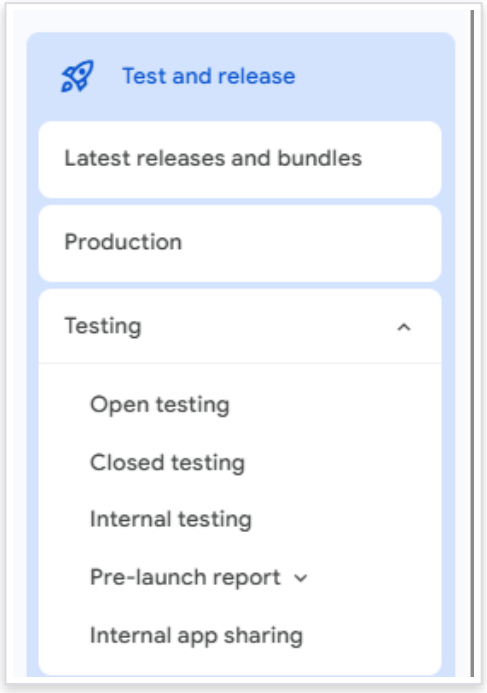
Green before you upload

- ☐ Signer is CN=Konnect (upload key)
- ☐ versionCode is higher than the last upload
- ☐ API host inside the bundle is the intended one
- ☐ Size is in the usual range (~88 MB)
- ☐ assembleRelease APK installs and signs in on a real phone
- ☐ Version bump is committed

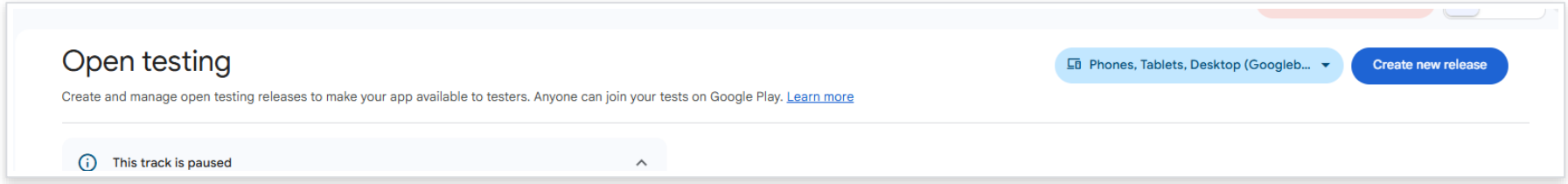
The APK (assembleRelease) is only for sideloading and device checks — Play accepts the AAB.

STEP 4 · PLAY CONSOLE

4 Upload to the Open testing track



Play Console · Test and release



Open testing page — "Create new release" (top right)

- Play Console → Konnect → Test and release → Testing → Open testing.
- Click Create new release (top right). The device selector stays on the default: Phones, Tablets, Desktop.
- "This track is paused" just means the previous test rollout was paused — starting the new rollout resumes it.
- Anyone can join an open test from the Play listing, so this is a public-but-quiet step: keep release notes user-facing.

Why Open testing first

It exercises the exact bundle Play will ship (re-signed by Play App Signing) on real devices, including Google and Facebook sign-in against the registered fingerprints. Production is then a promotion of that bundle, not a new upload.

STEP 4 (CONT.) · PLAY CONSOLE

4 Fill in the release: bundle, name, notes

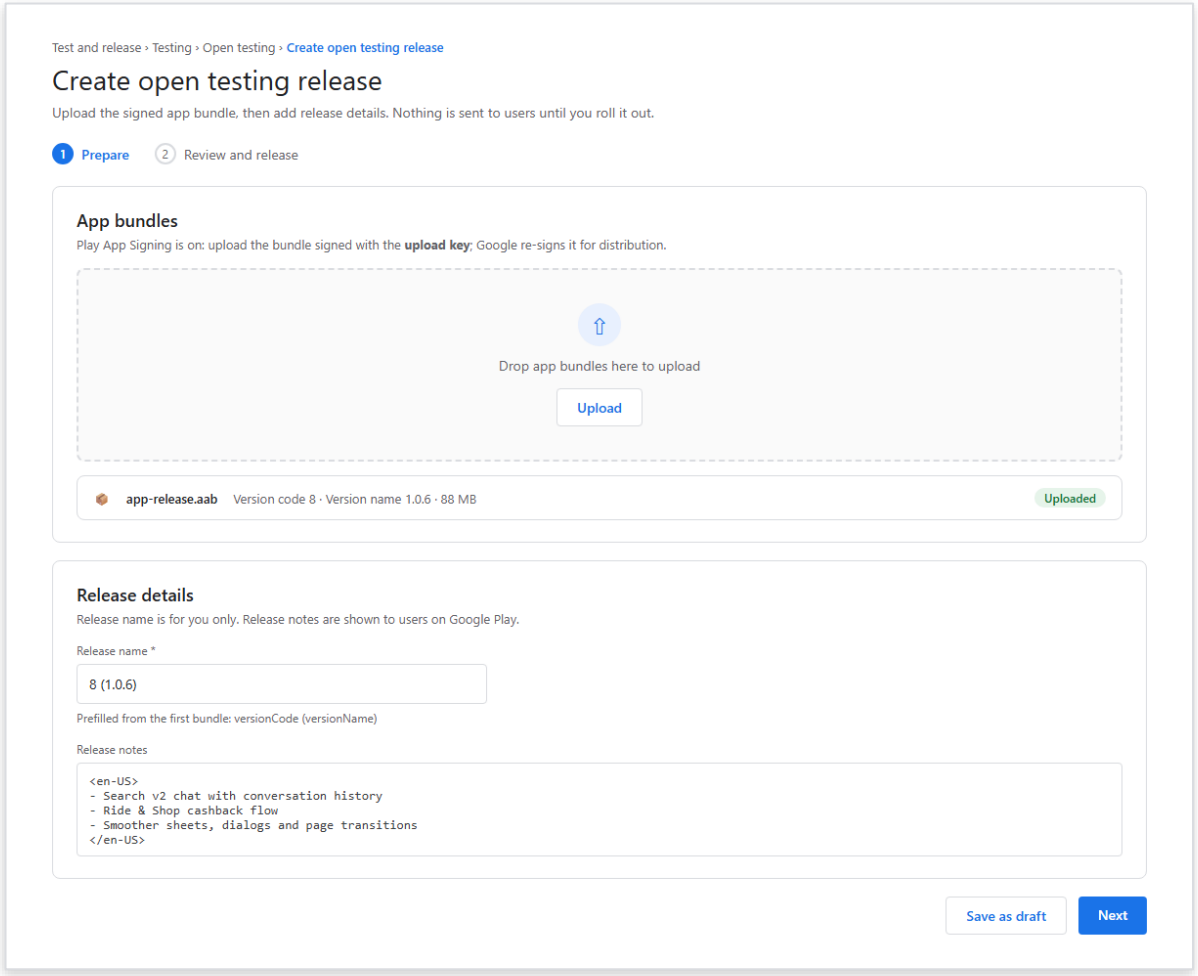


Illustration — mock-up of the Play Console "Create open testing release" form

- App bundles: upload release/konnect-v<ver>.aab and wait for the "Uploaded" chip. Play reads versionCode/versionName from it.
- Release name is prefilled as "<code> (<name>)", e.g. 8 (1.0.6) — keep it; it is how the release is listed everywhere.
- Release notes: inside <en-US> … </en-US>. These are shown to users on the store listing after Production.
- Next → takes you to Review and release. Save as draft if you need to stop here.
- Errors at this point are almost always version already used or wrong signing key — fix in the repo, rebuild, re-upload.

STEP 5 · PLAY CONSOLE + DEVICE

5 Roll out to testers and verify on a phone

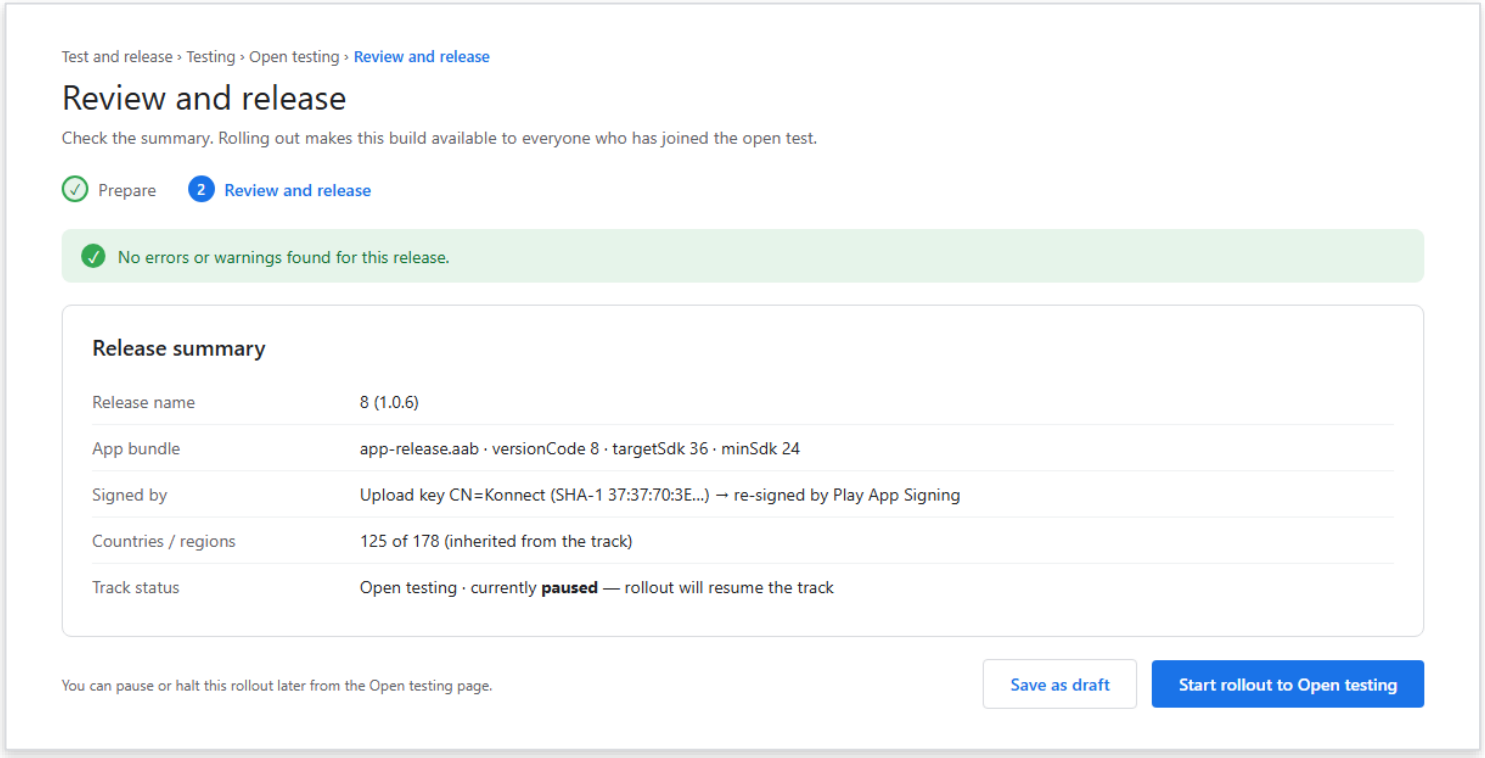


Illustration — mock-up of the "Review and release" summary before rollout

- Check the summary: no errors or warnings, right release name, right bundle.
- Start rollout to Open testing. Testers get the update within about an hour.
- Install it from Play (not adb) on at least one real phone and smoke-test: Google sign-in, Facebook sign-in, a search, History, the Ride & Shop cashback page.
- Sign-in is the canary: it fails only if the Play-signed certificate is not registered in Firebase / Facebook.
- Glance at the Pre-launch report (Testing → Pre-launch report) for crashes on Google's test devices.

STEP 6 · PLAY CONSOLE

6 Promote the same release to Production

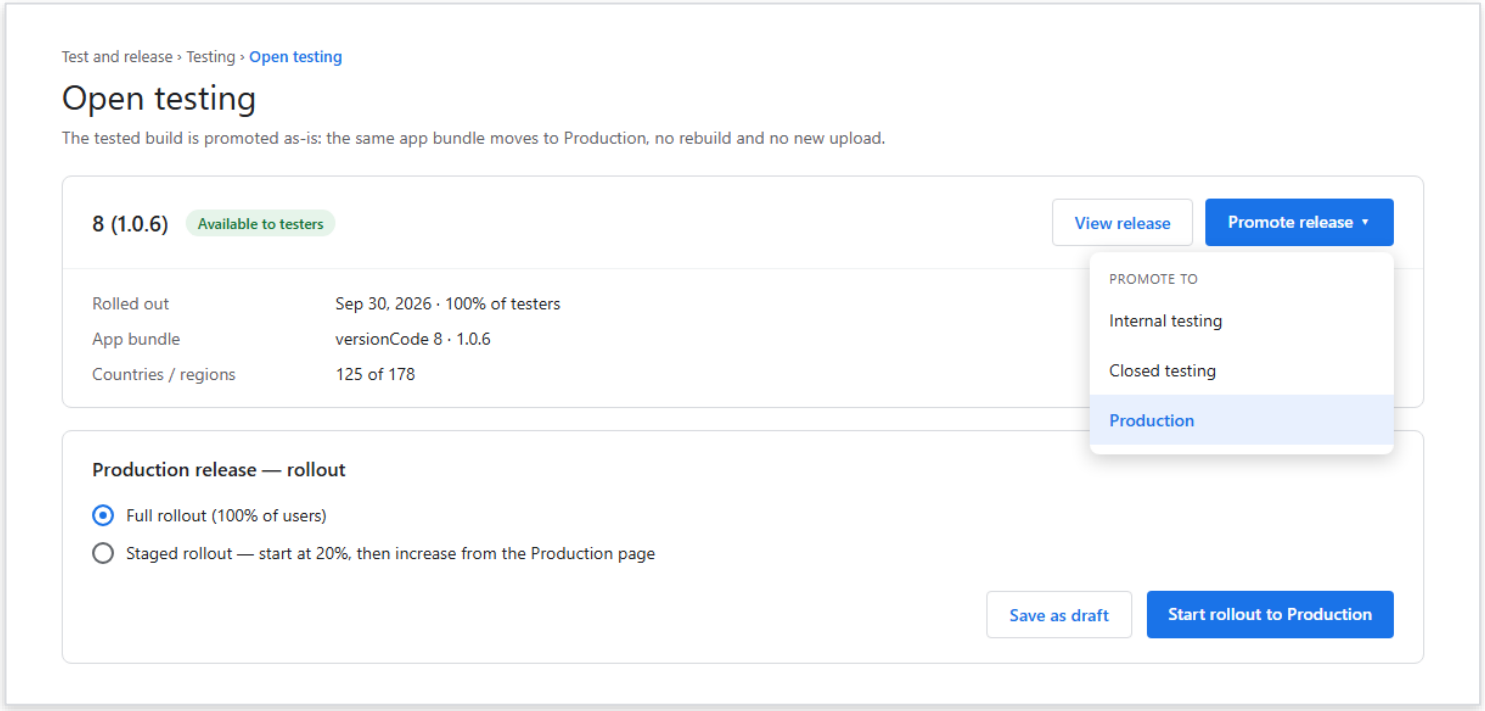


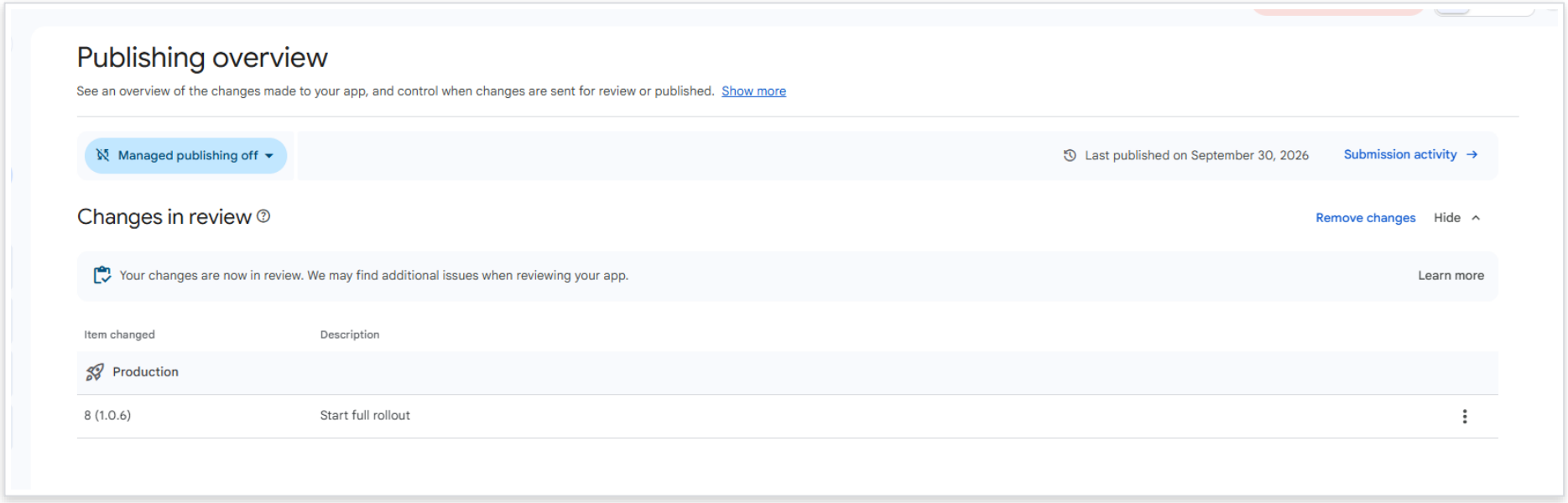
Illustration — mock-up of "Promote release ▾ → Production" on the Open testing page

- Open testing → the release card → Promote release → Production.
- Nothing is rebuilt or re-uploaded: the promoted release reuses the tested bundle and its notes.
- Choose the rollout: Full rollout (our current practice) or a staged percentage you raise later from the Production page.
- Start rollout to Production sends it to Google review. Users see nothing until the review passes.
- Countries/regions are inherited from the Production track (125 of 178 today).

STEP 7 · GOOGLE

7

Google review: watch Publishing overview



Publishing overview on Sep 30, 2026 — release 8 (1.0.6) waiting for review

- "Changes in review" lists what Google is looking at: here Production → 8 (1.0.6) → Start full rollout.
- Managed publishing is off: the moment Google approves, the release publishes itself. Turn it on only to hold an approved release for a launch date.
- Review usually takes hours, sometimes a few days for a first policy check. "Remove changes" withdraws the submission while it is still in review.

Where the time goes

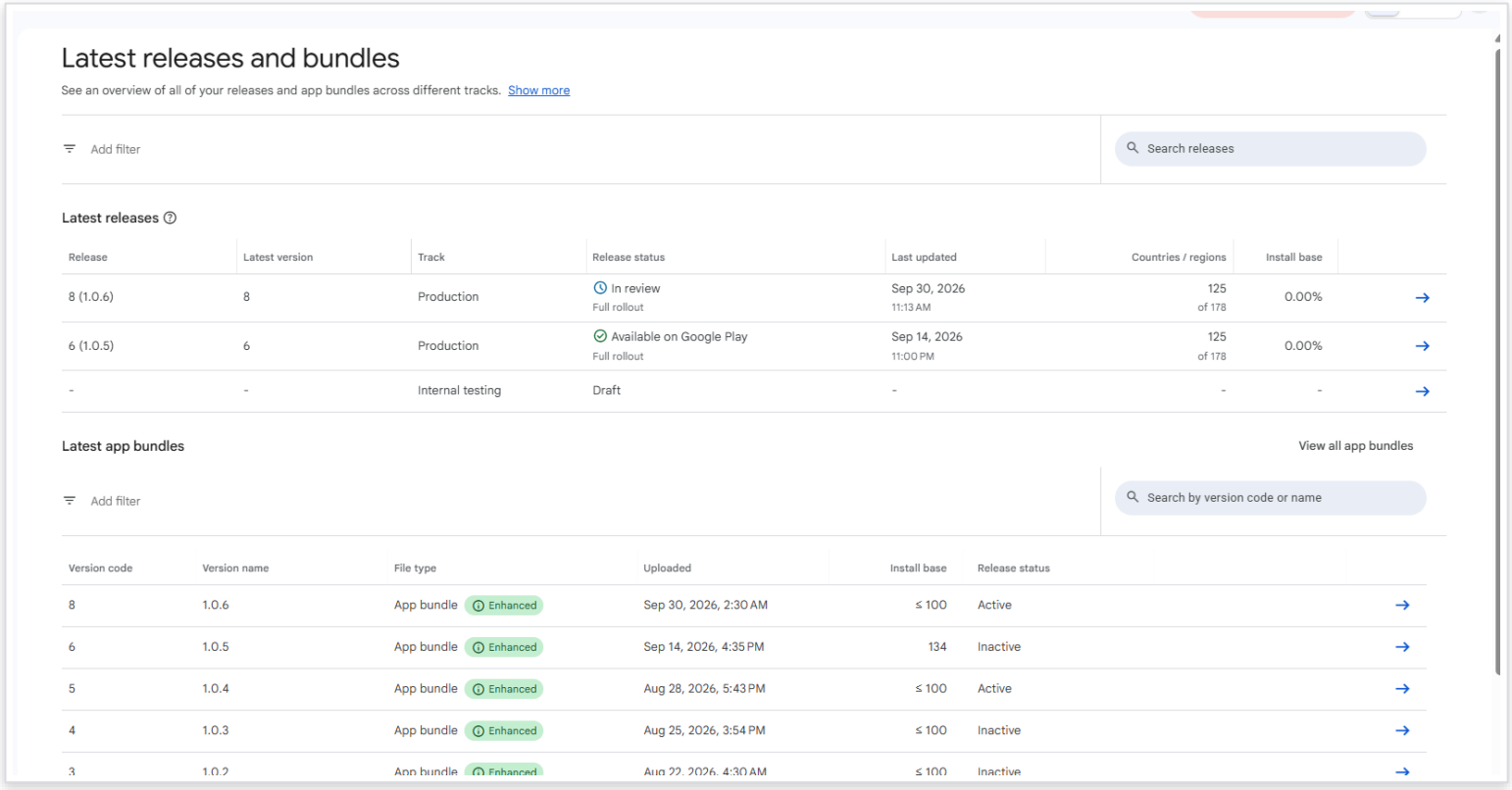
Sep 30 upload at 2:30 AM → Production release created 11:13 AM → "In review". Check Publishing overview once a day; no action is needed from us while it is in review.

If Google rejects

The rejection email and the Policy status page name the policy. Fix it in the app or the listing, bump versionCode, rebuild, and go back to step 1 — a rejected bundle cannot be resubmitted as-is.

STEP 8 · PLAY CONSOLE

8 Confirm it is live, then keep an eye on it



Latest releases and bundles — 8 (1.0.6) in review above the live 6 (1.0.5)

- Latest releases: the status flips from “In review” to “Available on Google Play”. That is the done signal.
- Latest app bundles: the new code becomes Active; the previous one goes Inactive.
- Install base and the crash rate (Quality → Android vitals) are worth a look for the first few days.
- Rollback is a new release with a higher versionCode — Play never installs a lower code on a device that already has the newer one.
- Keep the release/ folder and the git tag in sync with what is on Play, so the next person can rebuild exactly this version.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Upload rejected: “Version code N has already been used”	versionCode not higher than a code already on any track	Bump versionCode in android/app/build.gradle (and versionName + app.json), rebuild, re-upload.
Upload rejected: “signed in debug mode”	The four KONNECT_UPLOAD_* properties were not found, so Gradle fell back to debug.keystore	Add them to ~/.gradle/gradle.properties on the build machine; verify with keytool -printcert (Owner must be CN=Konnect).
Google / Facebook sign-in fails only in the store build	Play App Signing certificate fingerprint is not registered	Play Console → Setup → App signing: copy the app signing SHA-1/SHA-256 into Firebase (konnectbackend) and the Facebook app key hashes; re-download google-services.json.
App talks to staging (or the wrong host) in production	Host is compiled in at build time; Metro served a cached bundle from a previous build	Edit DEFAULT_API_HOST in src/config/index.ts, purge the Metro cache, gradlew clean, rebuild, and run the unzip/grep check on the AAB.
Open testing shows “This track is paused”	The previous open-test rollout was paused after promotion	Nothing to do — starting the new rollout resumes the track.
Release stuck “In review” for days	Manual policy review, usually after a listing or permission change	Wait; check Policy status and the inbox. Only “Remove changes” if you need to resubmit a different build.
Upload keystore lost	File deleted or laptop gone without a backup	Play Console → Setup → App signing → “Request upload key reset” (Play App Signing must be on). Then register the new fingerprints.

ONE PAGE

Release checklist — copy, tick, ship

Before the build

- ☐ Decide the API host for this release
- ☐ Bump versionCode (+1 or more) and versionName in build.gradle
- ☐ Set expo.version in app.json to the same versionName
- ☐ Commit the bump
- ☐ DEFAULT_API_HOST in src/config/index.ts is the intended host
- ☐ Metro cache purged, gradlew clean run

Build and verify

- ☐ gradlew bundleRelease succeeded
- ☐ AAB copied to release/konnect-v<ver>.aab
- ☐ keytool: Owner is CN=Konnect (not Android Debug)
- ☐ aapt2: versionCode/versionName are the new ones
- ☐ unzip/grep: exactly one host, the intended one
- ☐ Host constant committed together with the version bump

Play Console

- ☐ Open testing → Create new release → upload AAB
- ☐ Release name “<code> (<name>)” kept
- ☐ Release notes in <en-US> written for users
- ☐ Review shows no errors → Start rollout to Open testing
- ☐ Smoke test the Play-installed build: both sign-ins, search, History, cashback
- ☐ Promote release → Production → Start rollout

After

- ☐ Publishing overview shows “Changes in review”
- ☐ Status becomes “Available on Google Play”
- ☐ Tag the commit (v1.0.6) and note the code in the team channel
- ☐ Check Android vitals after 24–48 h
- ☐ Update this runbook if anything surprised you

REFERENCE

Where everything lives

Item	Location / value
Written runbook (source of truth)	`docs/RELEASE.md`
Version numbers	`app.json → expo.version` · `android/app/build.gradle → versionCode / versionName`
Default API host	`src/config/index.ts → DEFAULT_API_HOST` (staging today; change it here for a store release)
Build outputs	`android/app/build/outputs/bundle/release/app-release.aab` · `…/apk/release/app-release.apk`
Versioned artifacts kept locally	`release/konnect-v<ver>.aab` · `release/konnect-v<ver>.apk` · `release/konnect-latest.apk`
Upload keystore	`~/konnect-upload.keystore` · alias `konnect-upload` · SHA-1 `37:37:70:3E:…:C6:0D:33`
Signing credentials	`~/.gradle/gradle.properties → KONNECT_UPLOAD_STORE_FILE / STORE_PASSWORD / KEY_ALIAS / KEY_PASSWORD`
Play Console	`play.google.com/console → Konnect (com.konnect.kr) → Test and release`
Sign-in fingerprints	Firebase project `konnectbackend → Android app → fingerprints` · Facebook app `2266334640859593 → key hashes`
Android project	`android/` (generated by expo prebuild; not committed) — build from the local copy

Passwords are never in this deck or in the repo. They live only in ~/.gradle/gradle.properties on the release machine and in the team password manager.